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# Monetary Policy Shocks and Economic Growth in Morocco: A Factor-Augmented Vector Autoregression (FAVAR) Approach

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## Abstract:

*In response to the empirical anomalies relating to the use of VAR models in analysing the impact of monetary policy shocks, the Factor-Augmented VAR (FAVAR) models attempt to provide a practical solution. Moreover, these models, based on dynamic factor models (DFM), make it possible to summarize the information present in a large database into a small number of factors common to all the variables. In this paper, we analyse the effects of monetary policy shocks on economic growth using the FAVAR model on a large number of Moroccan macroeconomic time series (117 quarterly time series from 1985Q1 to 2018Q4). First, we present the econometric framework of the FAVAR model, then the data used and their necessary transformations. Next, we determine the number of factors before estimating the model. Then, we focus on the analysis of the impulse response functions of some indicators of economic growth in Morocco. The results of the analysis indicate that, the overall decline in GDP in response to monetary policy shocks suggests that they have a clearly negative impact on economic growth.*

**Key words:** Monetary policy shocks; Economic growth; Dynamic factor model; FAVAR; Morocco

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## I. Introduction

Currently, macroeconomic and financial data are increasingly available both in terms of number and length of series. The conduct of monetary policy by central banks takes place in an information-rich environment. In terms of econometric tools, the methods used in the analysis of monetary policy shocks generally refer to standard VAR models or their variants such as VECM (vector error-correction models) or SVARs (structural VAR models). However, it is known that the use of large amounts of information in these models is accompanied by dimensionality problems. In this paper we propose an approach in terms of FAVAR models (factor augmented VARs).

Bernanke et al. (2005), among others, recognize significant strengths in VAR models in their classical form. They note that VAR models provide empirical responses of economic variables to a monetary policy shock that are consistent with the relative simplicity of the model, which is its main strength. However, Bernanke et al. (2005) also point out some limitations associated with the use of VAR models to analyze monetary policy shocks. A first shortcoming is the disagreement over the most appropriate strategy for identifying shocks. A second limitation arises from the small number of variables used to maintain sufficient degrees of freedom for model estimation. Similarly, the limited number of variables used in the VAR model is far from covering the hundreds of variables tracked by economists and this fact can lead to two difficulties. First, the responses of the variables to shocks may be biased because of the absence of a large number of variables containing information used in decision making. Second, an inevitable consequence of VAR models is that the number of observable responses is constrained by the reduced number of variables in the model. However, we may be interested in the responses of variables not included in the model for reasons of degree of freedom.

To correct the weaknesses of VAR models, Bernanke et al. (2005) propose new information-rich econometric models. These models allocate Factor Augmented Autoregressive Vectors (FAVARs) based on the dynamic factor models (DFM) or diffusion indexes used by Stock and Watson (2005). Dynamic Factor Models are considered the tool for "big data" in macro-econometrics. These models apply to many contexts where econometricians seek to synthesize a large number of heterogeneous time series. They allow the common dynamics of a large number of macroeconomic variables to be summarized as a relatively small number of latent variables called factors. These models have proven to be very useful tools for shock analysis and economic forecasting.

In this paper, we will use the FAVAR model to analyze the impact of monetary policy shocks on economic growth in Morocco. The model used has allowed us to obtain impulse response functions for all

indicators in the macroeconomic data set used (117 quarterly series from 1985: Q1 to 2018: Q4) in order to have a more realistic and complete representation of the impact of monetary policy shocks on the Moroccan economy. However, in our analysis, we were interested only in the main indicators of economic growth in Morocco.

## II. Econometric framework of the FAVAR model

### 2.1 Dynamic and static forms:

Bernanke et al. (2005) mention that the factors will allow us to model certain concepts that are difficult to identify using one or two variables. Indeed, we will consider a number  $M$  of observable variables contained in the vector  $Y_t$  and  $K$  "factors" contained in the vector  $f_t$ , the dynamics of the economy is modelled by the following vector augmented factor model (FAVAR) :

$$\begin{bmatrix} f_t \\ Y_t \end{bmatrix} = \gamma(L) \begin{bmatrix} f_{t-1} \\ Y_{t-1} \end{bmatrix} + v_t \quad : \quad \forall t = 1, \dots, T \quad (1)$$

This Where  $\gamma(L)$  is a polynomial matrix including  $P$  lags and  $v_t$  is a vector of  $[(K + M) \times 1]$  containing the statistical innovations of null mean. The factors  $f_t$ , representing aggregate economic concepts, are by definition non-observable. However, we can consider a panel of  $N$  observable and informative economic series included in the  $X_t$  vector where  $N \gg K$  and  $N \gg M$  such that :

$$X_t = \lambda_f(L)f_t + \lambda_Y Y_t + e_t \quad : \quad \forall t = 1, \dots, T \quad (2)$$

Where  $\lambda_f(L)$  is a polynomial matrix including  $S$  lags and  $e_t$  is a  $[N \times 1]$  vector containing the statistical innovations of mean zero. The observable series of  $X_t$ , which can number in the tens or hundreds, share a common component described by the factors of  $f_t$  and  $Y_t$  and an idiosyncratic part represented by the residuals  $e_t$ . The factors of  $f_t$  and  $Y_t$  are considered orthogonal to the residuals of  $e_t$ . The residuals can be temporally correlated with the residuals of other variables, but the correlation should be limited. Under this assumption, the form of the FAVAR is called "approximated" (Stock and Watson, 2005). The aim is therefore to observe the responses of certain macroeconomic variables contained in  $X_t$  to structural shocks associated with the variables in  $Y_t$ . However, in order to estimate the factors, we must first transform the dynamic form into a static form.

As noted by Stock and Watson (2005), every FAVAR model has a static representation in which there are  $R$  static factors contained in the  $F_t$  vector that represent the present and past values of the  $K$  dynamic factors. In other words, if  $\lambda_f(L)$  in the equation (2) has  $S$  lags, then there will be  $R = K \times (S + 1)$  static factors such as  $F_t = [f_t f_{t-1} \dots f_{t-S}]$ . Based on equations (1) and (2), the static form of the FAVAR model is described by the following two equations:

$$X_t = \Lambda_F F_t + \Lambda_Y Y_t + E_t \quad : \quad \forall t = 1, \dots, T \quad (3)$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} F_t \\ Y_t \end{bmatrix} = \Gamma(L) \begin{bmatrix} F_{t-1} \\ Y_{t-1} \end{bmatrix} + V_t \quad : \quad \forall t = 1, \dots, T \quad (4)$$

Where  $F_t$  is a vector of size  $[R \times 1]$  containing the  $R$  static factors and  $\Gamma(L)$  a polynomial matrix with  $L$  lags. The residuals  $E_t$  and  $V_t$  are zero means.

To summarize, the dynamics of the economy and the transmission mechanisms are modelled by the FAVAR model of the equation (4). This FAVAR model allows the use of observable series contained in  $Y_t$ . These series are considered observable factors because they intervene directly in the dynamics of the economy to impact all economic variables. These series are supplemented by the non-observable factors  $F_t$  modelling economic concepts plus "diffuse". The equation (3) indicates that many of the economic series included in  $X_t$  are influenced by these factors, which represent the common component shared by the variables in  $X_t$ . This last equation will allow us to estimate the non-observable factors.

### 2.2 Estimation and identification of shocks:

Although the static factors  $F_t$  are not observable, the equation (4) will allow us to estimate them. Two estimation methods are generally used: the first is based on principal component estimation (PCA), the second is based on Bayesian likelihood estimation. However, the two-step PCA method has the non-negligible advantage of being non-parametric. Bernanke et al. (2005) propose to estimate unobservable factors in two steps. The first step is to estimate the non-observable factors from the equation (3). The second step consists in estimating the FAVAR of the equation (4).

Concerning the identification of structural shocks, the aim is to observe the responses of variables  $X_t$  to shocks associated with observable factors  $Y_t$ . However, the VAR model residuals of the equation (4) represent statistical innovations and not structural shocks. To identify the latter, let us write the structural form of the VAR model of equation (4):

$$\Phi \begin{bmatrix} F_t \\ Y_t \end{bmatrix} = \Theta(L) \begin{bmatrix} F_{t-1} \\ Y_{t-1} \end{bmatrix} + U_t \quad \forall t = 1, \dots, T \quad (5)$$

Where  $U_t$  is a vector that contains the structural shocks such that their variance covariance matrix is equal to  $I$ ; the unit matrix. From VAR models (equations 1 and 4), we can deduce:

$$U_t = \Phi V_t \quad \forall t = 1, \dots, T \quad (6)$$

To compute  $\Phi$ , we will apply a Cholesky decomposition to the variance covariance matrix  $\Sigma$  of the residuals  $V_t$  is equal to :  $\Sigma = E(V_t V_t') = \Phi^{-1} E_t(U_t U_t') \Phi^{-1'} = \Phi^{-1} \Phi^{-1'}$ . The latter allowing us to retrieve a lower triangular matrix  $\Phi^{-1}$ .

From equations (3), (4) and (6), we can calculate the moving average representation of  $X_t$  which is:

$$X_t = \Lambda[I - \Gamma(L)]^{-1} \Phi^{-1} U_t + E_t \quad \forall t = 1, \dots, T \quad (7)$$

From this representation, we will be able to study the responses of the variables  $X_t$  to a structural shock  $U_t$ .

### III. Empirical application

#### 3.1 Data and transformations:

As mentioned above, our database consists of 117 quarterly time series from 1985:Q1 to 2018:Q4. The variables used come mainly from monetary reports and statistics from Bank Al-Maghrib (BM), statistics from the Office of the High Commissioner for Planning (HCP), the Exchange Office (OC), the Casablanca Stock Exchange (BVC) and the International Financial Statistics of the International Monetary Fund (IMF). The different series are listed by category in Table (1), the full list of which is presented in Appendix. Due to the unavailability of certain variables at a quarterly frequency, the annual series have been quarterlyized, as have the monthly series.

**Table 1:** Time series in the database by categories

| #            | Categories                                    | Number of series | Frequency                                  | Source     |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1            | Gross Domestic Product by Industry, base 2007 | 21               | A: [1985 - 2006]<br>Q: [2007Q1 - 2018Q4].  | HCP        |
| 2            | Domestic production by industry, base 2007    | 16               | A: [1985 - 2018]                           | HCP        |
| 3            | Gross National Disposable Income, base 2007   | 7                | A: [1985 - 2006]<br>Q: [2007Q1 - 2018Q4].  | HCP        |
| 4            | Gross National Expenditure                    | 4                | A: [1985 - 2018]                           | BM         |
| 5            | Final consumption expenditure                 | 9                | A: [1985 - 2018]                           | IMF<br>HCP |
| 6            | Investments                                   | 7                | A: [1985 - 2018]                           | BM<br>HCP  |
| 7            | Currency                                      | 19               | M: [1985M1 - 2018M12].                     | BAM        |
| 8            | Stock market indicators                       | 3                | A: [1985 - 2001]<br>M: [2002M1 - 2018M12]. | BVC        |
| 9            | Gross national savings, base 2007             | 3                | A: [1985 - 2018]                           | HCP        |
| 10           | Inflation, Consumer Price Index               | 5                | Q: [1985Q1 - 2018Q4].                      | IMF        |
| 11           | Industrial Producer Price Index               | 2                | Q: [1985Q1 - 2018Q4].                      | IMF        |
| 12           | Unemployment rate                             | 1                | A: [1985 - 1995]<br>Q: [1996Q1 - 2018Q4].  | IMF        |
| 13           | Exchange rates                                | 6                | Q: [1985Q1 - 2018Q4].                      | IMF        |
| 14           | Interest rates                                | 4                | Q: [1985Q1 - 2018Q4].                      | IMF        |
| 15           | Foreign trade                                 | 10               | A: [1985 - 1997]<br>M: [1998M1 - 2018M12]. | IMF<br>OC  |
| <b>Total</b> |                                               | <b>117</b>       |                                            |            |

-Notes: A: Annual - Q: Quarterly - M: Monthly

-Source: Authors.

The data have undergone four preliminary transformations. First, in the DFM, the theory associated with these models assumes that the variables are second order stationary. For this reason, each series has been transformed to be approximately zero-order integrated. Decisions regarding these transformations were guided by unit root tests (ADF and Phillips Perron tests) combined with visual examination and/or a priori economic judgment. Second, for each series, outliers were detected and statistically corrected based on the interquartile range (IQR). Third, following Stock and Watson (2012), the long-term mean of each series was removed using a double-weighted filter with a bandwidth of 100 quarters. Fourth, after these transformations, the series were normalized to have a unit standard deviation and to make them comparable on the same scale. Similarly, estimating the FAVAR model using the two-step principal component method (PCA) requires prior normalization of the variables.

The use of the FAVAR model also requires dividing the sample into two groups, fast and slow variables, according to their speed of response to shocks. Monetary aggregates, stock market indicators, interest rates, and exchange rates are considered fast variables. In contrast, the remaining variables are considered slow variables.

### 3.2 Determination of the number of factors:

An important step before estimating the FAVAR model is to determine the number of static factors in the complete database. Indeed, we will use the criteria of Bai and Ng (2002) and Ahn and Horenstein (2013) respectively. Table (2) summarizes the factor number statistics: the marginal  $R^2$  of the factors (the numerical values corresponding to the bars in figure (1) showing the scree of eigenvalues), the  $IC_{p2}$  information criterion of Bai and Ng (2002) and the eigenvalue ratio of Ahn and Horenstein (2013).

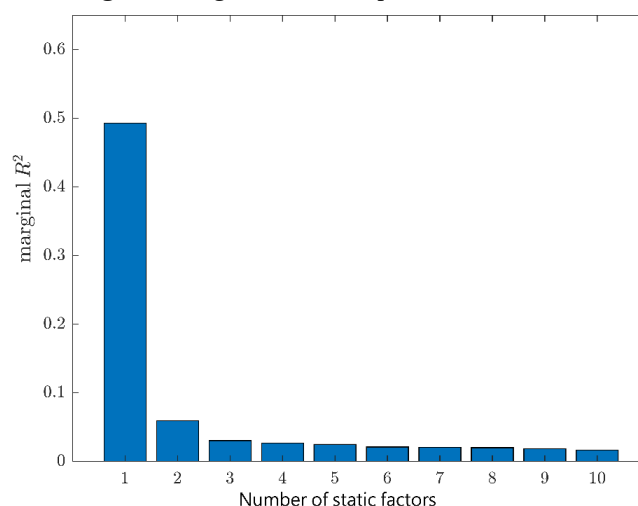
**Table 2:** Estimation of the number of static factors

| Number of static factors | Trace $R^2$ | Marginal trace $R^2$ | BN-ICp2       | AH-ER        |
|--------------------------|-------------|----------------------|---------------|--------------|
| 1                        | 0,493       | 0,493                | -0,603        | <b>8,286</b> |
| 2                        | 0,553       | 0,060                | <b>-0,651</b> | 1,961        |
| 3                        | 0,583       | 0,030                | -0,645        | 1,144        |
| 4                        | 0,609       | 0,027                | -0,634        | 1,065        |
| 5                        | 0,634       | 0,025                | -0,623        | 1,184        |
| 6                        | 0,655       | 0,021                | -0,606        | 1,021        |
| 7                        | 0,676       | 0,021                | -0,591        | 1,029        |
| 8                        | 0,696       | 0,020                | -0,578        | 1,088        |
| 9                        | 0,714       | 0,018                | -0,564        | 1,129        |
| 10                       | 0,731       | 0,016                | -0,546        | 1,072        |

- **Notes:** BN-ICp2 refers to the ICp2 information criterion of Bai and Ng (2002). AH-ER is the ratio of Ahn and Horenstein (2013) which is the ratio between the  $i^{th+1}$  and the  $i^{th}$  eigenvalue. In each column, the minimum value of BN-ICp2 and the maximum value of the Ahn-Horenstein ratio, which are shown in bold, represent the respective estimates of the number of factors.

- **Source:** Authors' calculations.

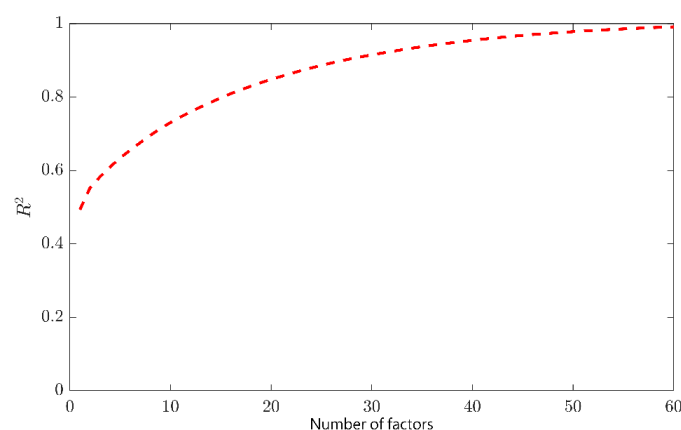
**Figure 1:** Eigenvalue scree plots for all data sets



**Source:** Authors' simulations.

As shown in figure (1), the dominant contribution to the trace of  $R^2$  of the 117 aggregates comes from the first factor which fully explains 49.3% of the variance of the 117 time series. Nevertheless, there are potentially significant contributions to  $R^2$  from the second and third factors: the marginal  $R^2$  of the second factor over the whole sample is 6%, that of the third factor is 3%. The total  $R^2$  of the first four factors is 61%, a significant increase from the 49.3% explained by the first factor alone. The  $IC_{p2}$  criterion of Bai and Ng (2002) estimates two factors, while the ratio of Ahn and Horenstein (2013) estimates only one factor. Similarly, figure (2) shows how the trace of  $R^2$  increases with the number of principal components (for a maximum of 60 principal components). This ambiguity is often encountered, in which case a judgment has to be made depending on the purpose for which the DFM is used. For the forecasting of economic growth, the sampling error associated with a large number of factors could exceed their predictive contribution. However, we can use more factors for structural analysis using DFMs because it is important that factor innovations cover the space of structural shocks and that the large number of factors capture variation.

**Figure 2:** Cumulative  $R^2$  as a function of the number of factors



Source: Authors' simulations.

In principle, there are at least two possible reasons why there could be more than one factor. The first possible reason is that there could be a single dynamic factor that manifests itself as multiple static factors. The number of dynamic factors can be estimated from the number of static factors. Then, applying the test of Amengual and Watson (2007) to the data set, with four static factors, it is estimated that there are only two dynamic factors (Table 3). However, the contribution to the  $R^2$  trace of possible additional dynamic factors remains significant in the economic sense, so the estimate of two dynamic factors is suggestive but inconclusive.

**Table 3:** Amenguel-Watson's estimate of the number of dynamic factors: BN-ICpi values

| Number of dynamic factors | Number of static factors |               |               |               |               |               |               |               |               |               |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
|                           | 1                        | 2             | 3             | 4             | 5             | 6             | 7             | 8             | 9             | 10            |
| 1                         | -0,382                   | -0,375        | -0,369        | -0,362        | -0,362        | -0,361        | -0,361        | -0,364        | -0,361        | -0,364        |
| 2                         |                          | <b>-0,399</b> | <b>-0,393</b> | <b>-0,383</b> | <b>-0,388</b> | <b>-0,387</b> | <b>-0,386</b> | <b>-0,388</b> | <b>-0,388</b> | <b>-0,382</b> |
| 3                         |                          |               | -0,380        | -0,373        | -0,379        | -0,375        | -0,376        | -0,377        | -0,378        | -0,372        |
| 4                         |                          |               |               | -0,360        | -0,362        | -0,356        | -0,355        | -0,356        | -0,359        | -0,355        |
| 5                         |                          |               |               |               | -0,338        | -0,332        | -0,331        | -0,334        | -0,339        | -0,337        |
| 6                         |                          |               |               |               |               | -0,309        | -0,308        | -0,312        | -0,317        | -0,315        |
| 7                         |                          |               |               |               |               |               | -0,287        | -0,291        | -0,297        | -0,296        |
| 8                         |                          |               |               |               |               |               |               | -0,272        | -0,279        | -0,278        |
| 9                         |                          |               |               |               |               |               |               |               | -0,257        | -0,257        |
| 10                        |                          |               |               |               |               |               |               |               |               | -0,236        |

- **Notes:** The values of BN-ICp2 are calculated using the covariance matrix of the residuals of the regression of the variables on the lagged values of the number of static factors in the column, estimated by the principal components.

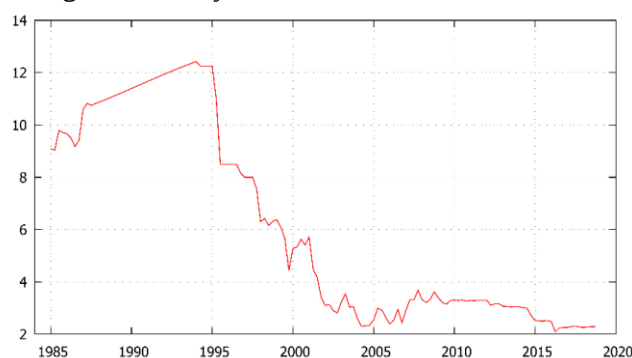
- **Source:** Authors' calculations.

The second possible reason is that these series vary in response to multiple structural shocks and that their responses to these shocks are sufficiently different that innovations to their common components cover the space of more than one aggregate shock.

### 3.3 Empirical results:

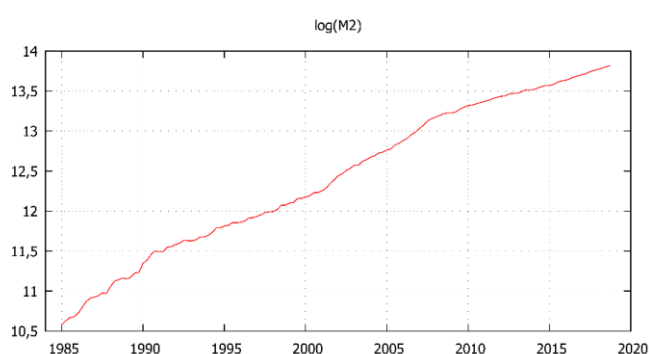
Using the FAVAR model of equation (4), as Bernanke et al. (2005) and Boivin et al. (2010) do, the aim is to observe the responses of certain macroeconomic variables contained in  $X_t$  to structural shocks associated with the variable contained in  $Y_t$ . Indeed, this FAVAR model offers us the possibility to study the responses of all the variables contained in  $X_t$ , i.e. 117 impulse response functions. However, we are only interested in the main indicators of economic growth. In order to choose the global number of lags of a FAVAR model, we will usually use the traditional information criteria. These criteria, calculated on our FAVAR model, for  $Y_t$  represents the money market interest rate (MMIR), allow us to retain an optimal lag of 2. However, for the FAVAR model where  $Y_t$  represents the money supply (M2) the optimal lag found is 4. The evolutions of these two variables, MMIR and M2, are presented respectively in figures (3) and (4).

**Figure 3: Money Market Interest Rates in Morocco**



Source: Authors, based on data from BAM.

**Figure 4: M2 Money Supply in Morocco (in logarithm)**



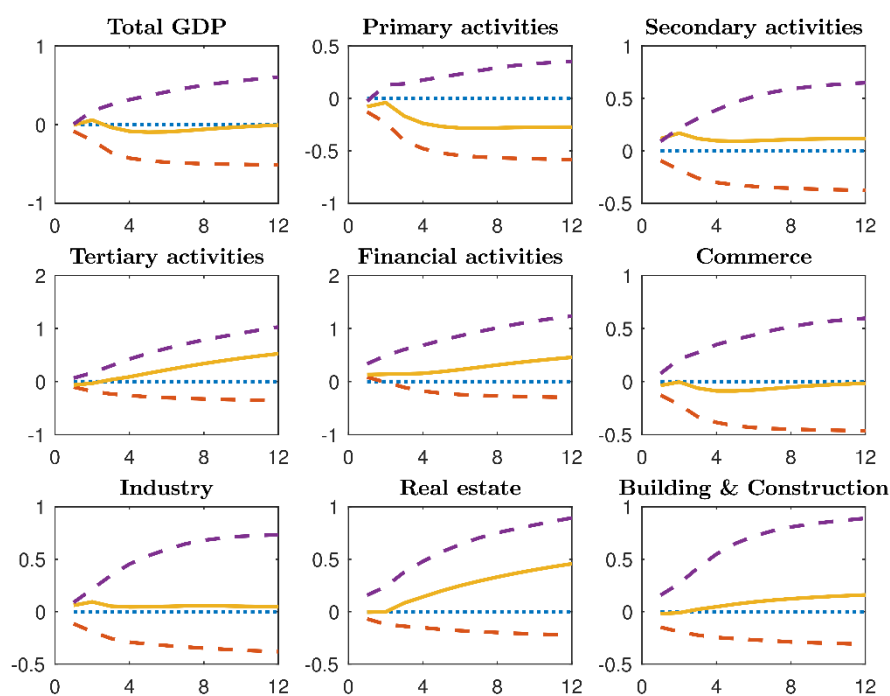
Source: Authors, based on data from BAM.

In fact, we have chosen this number of lags so that the residues of our FAVAR model can be considered as white noise. Our first FAVAR model therefore has 2 lags, 2 non-observable factors and only one observable factor (normalized first-difference money market interest rate). However, in our second model, where  $Y_t$  represents M2, there are 4 lags, 2 unobservable factors and only one observable factor (the money aggregate M2 in log first-difference and normalized). We therefore simulate the effects of a 25-basis-point increase in the money market interest rate (MMIR) and then in the monetary aggregate M2 (money supply shock) on Moroccan economic growth as measured by the few indicators of GDP by industry.

The impulse responses of variables representative of economic growth, by branch of activity, to these two types of restrictive monetary policy shocks are presented respectively in figures (5) and (6) with 95% confidence intervals. We adopt the bootstrap procedure of Kilian (1998) which takes into account the uncertainty of the factor estimates in order to obtain more precise confidence intervals for the response functions of the variables. Indeed, the impulse responses show no significant anomaly.

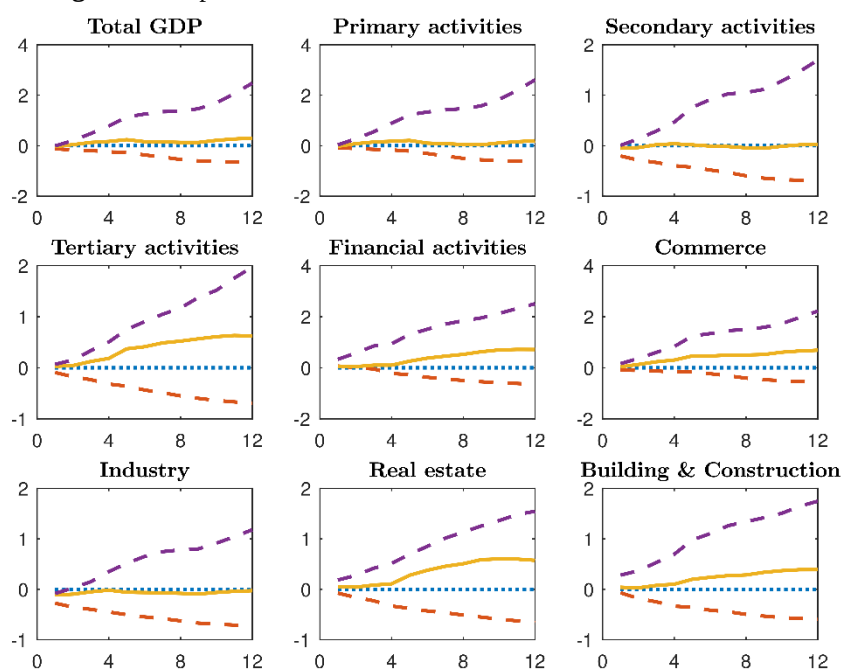
From figure (5), we observe that the shock of restrictive monetary policy (an increase in the money market interest rate) causes a slight decrease in total GDP and trade GDP, while it causes a remarkable decrease in GDP relative to tertiary activities as early as the second quarter following the shock. The fall in total GDP and trade GDP gradually weakens from the 8th quarter onwards to return to its initial state. However, the other GDP indicators studied show an almost negligible increase.

**Figure 5:** Responses of Economic Growth Indicators to a Money Market Interest Rate Shock



Source: Authors' simulations.

**Figure 6:** Responses of Economic Growth Indicators to an M2 Shock



Source: Authors' simulations.

Moreover, in figure (6), the money supply shock (M2 shock) essentially causes a very slight decrease in industrial GDP. On the other hand, we observe a gradual increase in real estate GDP and GDP of financial activities from the 4th quarter onwards. We find almost the same behavior with respect to the GDP for construction and public works, but in a less strong way. The remaining variables do not show strong reactions to this category of monetary policy shock.

Tables (4) and (5) present, respectively for a TIMM and M2 shock, the results of the variance and  $R^2$  decomposition for the economic growth indicators previously illustrated in figures (5) and (6). For each type of



shock, the money market interest rate (MMIR) and the money supply (M2), the first column shows the contribution of the monetary policy shock to the variance of the forecast error at a 12-quarter horizon. The second column contains the  $R^2$  of the common component for each of the variables studied.

**Table 4:** Analysis of the decomposition of variance and  $R^2$  of a TIMM shock

| Variable                | Variance decomposition | $R^2$  |
|-------------------------|------------------------|--------|
| Total GDP               | 0,0135                 | 0,8269 |
| Primary activities      | 0,0325                 | 0,7955 |
| Secondary activities    | 0,0184                 | 0,7424 |
| Tertiary activities     | 0,0312                 | 0,653  |
| Financial activities    | 0,0332                 | 0,5692 |
| Commerce                | 0,0124                 | 0,4475 |
| Industry                | 0,0083                 | 0,6029 |
| Real estate             | 0,0374                 | 0,3400 |
| Building & Construction | 0,0103                 | 0,1976 |

- **Notes:** The column entitled "variance decomposition" shows the fraction of the variance of the forecast error, at the 12-quarter horizon, explained by the monetary policy shock.  $R^2$  refers to the fraction of the variance of the variable explained by the common factors.

- **Source:** Authors' calculations.

**Table 5:** Analysis of the decomposition of variance and  $R^2$  of a M2 shock

| Variable                | Variance decomposition | $R^2$  |
|-------------------------|------------------------|--------|
| Total GDP               | 0,0144                 | 0,8239 |
| Primary activities      | 0,0119                 | 0,8124 |
| Secondary activities    | 0,0056                 | 0,7079 |
| Tertiary activities     | 0,0332                 | 0,6358 |
| Financial activities    | 0,0278                 | 0,6376 |
| Commerce                | 0,0445                 | 0,4490 |
| Industry                | 0,0172                 | 0,5921 |
| Real estate             | 0,0419                 | 0,3912 |
| Building & Construction | 0,0307                 | 0,2120 |

- **Notes:** The column entitled "variance decomposition" shows the fraction of the variance of the forecast error, at the 12-quarter horizon, explained by the monetary policy shock.  $R^2$  refers to the fraction of the variance of the variable explained by the common factors.

- **Source:** Authors' calculations.

Indeed, the contribution of the money market interest rate shock (MMIR) to the variance of the forecast error is between 1.03% and 3.74%. In particular, this shock explains respectively 1.35%, 3.32% and 3.74% of the forecast error of total GDP, GDP of financial activities and real estate GDP. On the other hand, the contribution of the M2 shock is between 0.56% (GDP of secondary activities) and 4.45% (GDP - trade). This suggests that the effects of these two monetary policy shocks on economic growth are relatively small.

The  $R^2$  analysis indicates that the  $R^2$  of GDP construction, GDP real estate and GDP trade are particularly low, suggesting that we should have less confidence in the estimates of the impulse response of these variables. However, the variance of the factors estimated in the FAVAR model explains a large percentage of the variance of the remaining variables.

## IV. Conclusion

The use of the FAVAR models is all the more relevant because of the use of a rich database, which allowed us to analyze the responses of some representative indicators of economic growth to monetary policy shocks (money market interest rate and money supply shocks) in Morocco.

Overall, the FAVAR model simulations show that monetary policy shocks influence the evolution of the main indicators of economic growth. Indeed, the analysis of impulse responses shows that the effect of a tightening of monetary policy (money market interest rate shock) leads, in the second quarter following the shock, to a decline in total GDP, GDP of primary activities, GDP of tertiary activities, and GDP of trade. On the other hand, the money supply shock (M2 shock) essentially leads to a decrease in GDP Industry. The overall decline in GDP in response to these two types of monetary policy shocks, in the short run, therefore suggests that they have a clearly negative impact on economic growth.

Finally, there is one area for improvement that deserves to be studied. This involves combining the FAVAR models and the time-varying parameter approach (Time-Varying FAVAR) in order to shed light on the question of whether the transmission mechanism of monetary policy shocks in Morocco has changed over time and, if so, how.

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### Appendix: Data Description

The database is composed of 117 time series at quarterly frequency from 1985:Q1 to 2018:Q4. “Fast” variables are denoted with an asterisk (\*), the remaining block of variables is considered “slow”. The transformation of the variables to make them stationary is done according to the transformation codes (TC) below:

- No transformation:  $X_{it} = Y_{it}$
- First difference:  $X_{it} = \Delta Y_{it}$
- Second difference:  $X_{it} = \Delta^2 Y_{it}$
- Logarithm  $X_{it} = \log Y_{it}$
- First difference of logarithm:  $X_{it} = \Delta \log Y_{it}$
- Second difference of logarithm:  $X_{it} = \Delta^2 \log Y_{it}$

| #                                                                     | Mnemonic | Description                                            | TC |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>Gross Domestic Product by branch of activity, base 2007 (MMAD)</b> |          |                                                        |    |
| 1                                                                     | TGDP     | Gross Domestic Product (Total)                         | 5  |
| 2                                                                     | GDPFIA   | GDP: Financial and insurance activities                | 5  |
| 3                                                                     | GDPPA    | GDP: Primary Activities                                | 5  |
| 4                                                                     | GDPPASS  | GDP: General public administration and social security | 5  |
| 5                                                                     | GDPSA    | GDP: Secondary activities                              | 5  |
| 6                                                                     | GDPONFS  | GDP: Other Non-Financial Services                      | 5  |
| 7                                                                     | GDPTA    | GDP: Tertiary activities                               | 5  |
| 8                                                                     | GDPBPW   | GDP: Building and Public Works                         | 5  |
| 9                                                                     | GDPT     | GDP: Trade                                             | 5  |
| 10                                                                    | GDPEGW   | GDP: Electricity, gas and water                        | 5  |
| 11                                                                    | GDPEHSA  | GDP: Education, Health and Social Action               | 5  |
| 12                                                                    | GDPEP    | GDP : excluding primary                                | 5  |
| 13                                                                    | GDPHR    | GDP: Hotels and restaurants                            | 5  |
| 14                                                                    | GDPEI    | GDP: Extraction industry                               | 5  |
| 15                                                                    | GDPREBBS | GDP: Real estate, rentals and business services        | 5  |
| 16                                                                    | GDPMI    | GDP: Manufacturing industry                            | 5  |
| 17                                                                    | GDPTPS   | GDP: Taxes on products net of subsidies                | 5  |
| 18                                                                    | GDPPT    | GDP: Post and telecommunications                       | 5  |
| 19                                                                    | GDPTI    | GDP: Total Industries                                  | 5  |
| 20                                                                    | GDPT     | GDP: Transportation                                    | 5  |
| 21                                                                    | GDPNA    | GDP: non-agricultural AV                               | 5  |
| <b>National production by branch of activity, base 2007 (MMAD)</b>    |          |                                                        |    |
| 22                                                                    | NPTBL    | NP: Total business lines                               | 5  |
| 23                                                                    | NPGPASS  | NP: General Public Administration and Social Security  | 5  |
| 24                                                                    | NPFIA    | NP: Financial and Insurance Activities                 | 5  |
| 25                                                                    | NPPA     | NP: Primary Activities                                 | 5  |
| 26                                                                    | NPONFS   | NP: Other Non-Financial Services                       | 5  |
| 27                                                                    | NBPBW    | NP: Building and Public Works                          | 5  |
| 28                                                                    | NPT      | NP: Trade                                              | 5  |
| 29                                                                    | NPEGW    | NP: Electricity, gas and water                         | 5  |
| 30                                                                    | NPEHSA   | NP: Education, Health and Social Action                | 6  |
| 31                                                                    | NPHR     | NP: Hotels and Restaurants                             | 5  |
| 32                                                                    | NPEI     | NP: Extraction Industry                                | 5  |
| 33                                                                    | NPREBBS  | NP: Real Estate, Rental and Business Services          | 6  |
| 34                                                                    | NPMI     | NP: Manufacturing Industry                             | 5  |
| 35                                                                    | NPPT     | NP: Post and Telecommunications                        | 5  |

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|                                                                            |          |                                                                       |   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| 36                                                                         | NPRPOEP  | NP: Refining of Petroleum and Other Energy Products                   | 2 |
| 37                                                                         | NPT      | NP: Transportation                                                    | 5 |
| <b>Gross National Disposable Income, base 2007 (In million MAD)</b>        |          |                                                                       |   |
| 38                                                                         | FCE      | Final consumption expenditure                                         | 5 |
| 39                                                                         | FCEGG    | Final consumption expenditure general government                      | 5 |
| 40                                                                         | HFCE     | Household final consumption expenditure                               | 2 |
| 41                                                                         | GNI      | Gross National Income                                                 | 2 |
| 42                                                                         | GNDI     | Gross National Disposable Income                                      | 2 |
| 43                                                                         | NPIS     | Net property income from external sources                             | 2 |
| 44                                                                         | NCTA     | Net current transfers from abroad                                     | 5 |
| <b>Gross National Expenditure</b>                                          |          |                                                                       |   |
| 45                                                                         | GNED     | Gross national expenditure deflator                                   | 2 |
| 46                                                                         | GNECU    | Gross national expenditure (units of local currency in current)       | 5 |
| 47                                                                         | GNECO    | Gross national expenditure (local currency units in constant dollars) | 5 |
| 48                                                                         | GNEGDP   | Gross national expenditure (% of GDP)                                 | 2 |
| <b>Final consumption expenditure</b>                                       |          |                                                                       |   |
| 49                                                                         | FCECU    | Final consumption expenditure (current MAD)                           | 5 |
| 50                                                                         | FCECO    | Final consumption expenditure (constant MAD)                          | 5 |
| 51                                                                         | HDCCU    | Household final consumption at current prices                         | 5 |
| 52                                                                         | FCEHNGDP | Final consumption expenditure of households and NPISHs (% of GDP)     | 2 |
| 53                                                                         | FCENNCU  | Final consumption expenditure, nominal, national currency             | 5 |
| 54                                                                         | FCENGDP  | Final consumption expenditure, nominal, ratio to GDP, percentage      | 2 |
| 55                                                                         | FCEPSN   | Final consumption expenditure, private sector, nominal, MAD           | 2 |
| 56                                                                         | FCEGDP   | Final consumption expenditure (% of GDP)                              | 2 |
| 57                                                                         | FCEPS    | Final consumption expenditure, public sector, MAD                     | 5 |
| <b>Investments</b>                                                         |          |                                                                       |   |
| 58                                                                         | INVR     | Investment rate                                                       | 2 |
| 59                                                                         | GIR      | Gross investment rate                                                 | 2 |
| 60                                                                         | FDINI    | Foreign direct investment, net inflows (% of GDP)                     | 2 |
| 61                                                                         | FDINO    | Foreign direct investment, net outflows (% of GDP)                    | 2 |
| 62                                                                         | GFCFGR   | Gross fixed capital formation (% growth)                              | 2 |
| 63                                                                         | GFCFCO   | Gross fixed capital formation (constant MAD)                          | 5 |
| 64                                                                         | GFCFCU   | Gross fixed capital formation (current MAD)                           | 5 |
| <b>Currency (In MMAD)</b>                                                  |          |                                                                       |   |
| 65                                                                         | M1*      | M1                                                                    | 5 |
| 66                                                                         | M2*      | M2                                                                    | 5 |
| 67                                                                         | M3*      | M3                                                                    | 5 |
| 68                                                                         | ORA*     | Official reserve assets                                               | 2 |
| 69                                                                         | BCC*     | Banknotes and coins in circulation                                    | 5 |
| 70                                                                         | TACVB*   | Term accounts and cash vouchers with banks                            | 2 |
| 71                                                                         | SAB*     | Savings accounts with banks                                           | 4 |
| 72                                                                         | FCIR*    | Fiduciary Circulation                                                 | 5 |
| 73                                                                         | NRBAM*   | Net receivables from BAM                                              | 2 |
| 74                                                                         | REC*     | Receivables                                                           | 2 |
| 75                                                                         | DDEP*    | Demand deposit                                                        | 2 |
| 76                                                                         | SDBAM*   | Sight deposits with BAM                                               | 2 |
| 77                                                                         | SDBKS*   | Sight deposits with banks                                             | 2 |
| 78                                                                         | DDEPTR*  | Demand deposits with the Treasury                                     | 2 |
| 79                                                                         | CBKS*    | Cash at banks                                                         | 2 |
| 80                                                                         | COMM*    | Commitments                                                           | 2 |
| 81                                                                         | SINV*    | Sight Investments                                                     | 5 |
| 82                                                                         | NIRES*   | Net International Reserves                                            | 2 |
| 83                                                                         | OMASS*   | Other monetary assets                                                 | 2 |
| <b>Stock market indicators</b>                                             |          |                                                                       |   |
| 84                                                                         | SETUR*   | Stock exchange turnover (In MMAD)                                     | 2 |
| 85                                                                         | MCAP*    | Market capitalization (in millions of MAD)                            | 2 |
| 86                                                                         | DIVD*    | Dividends (In Millions of MAD)                                        | 5 |
| <b>Gross national savings, 2007 base (in millions of Moroccan dirhams)</b> |          |                                                                       |   |
| 87                                                                         | GNS      | Gross national savings                                                | 2 |
| 88                                                                         | GDS      | Gross domestic savings                                                | 2 |
| 89                                                                         | EXTS     | External savings                                                      | 2 |
| <b>Inflation, Consumer Price Index</b>                                     |          |                                                                       |   |
| 90                                                                         | INFGDP   | Inflation, GDP deflator (in %)                                        | 2 |
| 91                                                                         | INFCP    | Inflation, consumer prices (in %)                                     | 1 |
| 92                                                                         | CPI      | Consumer Price Index (2010 = 100)                                     | 4 |
| 93                                                                         | CPIPY    | CPI, Corresponding period of the previous year (in %)                 | 2 |
| 94                                                                         | CPOPP    | CPI, Previous period (in %)                                           | 1 |
| <b>Industrial producer price index</b>                                     |          |                                                                       |   |
| 95                                                                         | IPPIMAN  | Industrial producer price index, manufacturing                        | 2 |
| 96                                                                         | IPPIMIN  | Industrial producer price index, mining                               | 2 |
| <b>Unemployment rate</b>                                                   |          |                                                                       |   |

|                       |           |                                                                                                   |   |
|-----------------------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| 97                    | UMPR      | Unemployment rate                                                                                 | 2 |
| <b>Exchange rates</b> |           |                                                                                                   |   |
| 98                    | ILTREGFE* | International Liquidity, Total reserves excluding gold, foreign exchange, SDR (Million)           | 2 |
| 99                    | ILTREGFC* | International Liquidity, Total reserves excluding gold, foreign currencies, US dollars. (Million) | 2 |
| 100                   | ERMADSDR* | Exchange rate, MAD per SDR, average for the period                                                | 2 |
| 101                   | ERMADEUR* | Exchange rates, MAD per euro, Average for the period                                              | 1 |
| 102                   | ERMADUSD* | Exchange rate, MAD per US Dollar, average for the period                                          | 2 |
| 103                   | NEERI*    | Exchange rate, Nominal effective exchange rate, Index                                             | 2 |
| <b>Interest rates</b> |           |                                                                                                   |   |
| 104                   | IRDEP*    | Interest rate, Deposit,                                                                           | 2 |
| 105                   | IRDIS*    | Interest rate, discount                                                                           | 2 |
| 106                   | MMIR*     | Interest rate, money market                                                                       | 2 |
| 107                   | IRGBYSMT* | Interest rates, government bond yields, short and medium term % %.                                | 2 |
| <b>Foreign trade</b>  |           |                                                                                                   |   |
| 108                   | EBGS      | External balance of goods and services (% of GDP)                                                 | 2 |
| 109                   | TRAGDP    | Trade (% of GDP)                                                                                  | 2 |
| 110                   | EGSCU     | Exports of goods and services (current MAD)                                                       | 2 |
| 111                   | EGSCO     | Exports of goods and services (constant MAD)                                                      | 2 |
| 112                   | EGSGDP    | Exports of goods and services (% of GDP)                                                          | 2 |
| 113                   | IMPGSCU   | Imports of goods and services (current MAD)                                                       | 2 |
| 114                   | IMPGSCO   | Imports of goods and services (constant MAD)                                                      | 2 |
| 115                   | IMPGSGDP  | Imports of goods and services (% of GDP)                                                          | 2 |
| 116                   | EXTBGSCU  | External balance in goods and services (current MAD)                                              | 2 |
| 117                   | EXTBGSCO  | External balance in goods and services (constant MAD)                                             | 2 |

- Source: Authors.

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